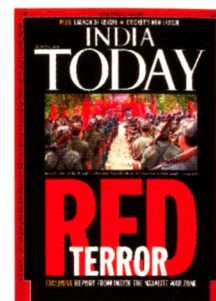


MAHADEO SEN



"Red Terror",
February 11, 2008

"Our lives are becoming colourful day by day. We have dealt with white lies, black markets and yellow journalism. It's now the turn of red terror."

CHANDER M. BHAT, *on e-mail*

A State of Siege

If the scourge of Naxalism continues to grow at this pace, the country will undoubtedly be in a situation similar to Nepal in a not-too-distant future ("Red Terror", February 11).
K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

The state should adopt a multi-pronged strategy to catch the Naxalites, which should take care of the sensitivities of the people of the backward region. Such an approach would eventually be able to break the stranglehold of these extremists as well as wean away large sections of people currently in its thrall.

P. PRASAND THAMPY,
Thiruvalla, Kerala

Our administrators are like the police of Bollywood. Just as the police in films reaches the scene of crime at the last moment when the drama is over, our ad-

ministrators are too lazy to act and stamp out the menace of Naxalism.

RAJNEESH BATRA, *Delhi*

Both the Congress and the two communist parties are responsible for the spread of Naxal terrorism. All these parties have at one point of time or the other been sympathetic to their cause.

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

Naxalites are a product of inefficient and decaying socio-economic system. They should not be treated as terrorists or criminals. The solution to this menace lies in good, efficient and corruption-free governance focusing on economic security, equal land distribution and decentralisation of power at village level.

VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

We should not romanticise or eulogise the Maoists who are nothing but a set

of terrorists out to destroy a civilised society under the garb of championing the cause of the downtrodden. There is no place for armed action to get justice, howsoever relevant the cause may be.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Ecologically Economic

Eco-friendly buildings should be promoted in a big way so that they become popular among the common man, which will go a long way in saving money, fuel and reducing global warming ("Green Heights", February 11).

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

Organ-ised Deception

The kidney racket is outrageous ("The Kidney Mafia", February 11). It would be better if the Government legalised organ donation to stop such mafias from operating.
VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

French Connection

It is good that India has developed a good relationship with France ("The New Best Friend", February 11). Their offer to sell civilian nuclear reactors to the country is bound to reduce our dependency on the US in near future. Such generous friends are necessary for India to tackle enemy nations around it.

ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

Latest on Mahatma

The review of the latest edition of *The Men who Killed Gandhi* ("Anniversary Addition", February 11) revived old memories and reminded me of my college days when I had first read the book. Though the first edition of the book was published by Macmillan India, Roli Books deserves praise for publishing it on the Mahatma's 60th death anniversary and for adding